

044. Chapter 4 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।
अपरं भवतो जन्म परं जन्म विवस्वतः ।
कथमेतद्विजानीयां त्वमादौ प्रोक्तवानिति ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
aparaṁ bhavato janma
paraṁ janma vivasvataḥ |
kathametadvijānīyāṁ
tvamādau proktavāniti ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ aparaṁ – later; bhavataḥ – Your; janma – birth; ◆ paraṁ – prior/ancient; janma – birth; vivasvataḥ – of Vivasvan; ◆ katham – how; etat – this; vijānīyāṁ – should I understand; ◆ tvam – You; ādau – in the beginning; proktavān – taught; iti – thus.

Arjuna said: Later was your birth, earlier the birth of Vivasvan (Sun); how then am I to understand that you taught it to him in the beginning?

VERSE 4.5

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
बहूनि मे व्यतीतानि जन्मानि तव चार्जुन ।
तान्यहं वेद सर्वाणि न त्वं वेत्थ परन्तप ॥ 5 ॥*

śrībhagavānuvāca |
bahūni me vyatītāni
janmāni tava cārjuna |
tānyaham veda sarvāṇi
na tvam vettha parantapa ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ bahūni – many; me – My; vyatītāni – have passed; ◆ janmāni – births; tava – your; ca – and; arjuna – O Arjuna; ◆ tāni – them; aham – I; veda – know; sarvāṇi – all; ◆ na – not; tvam – you; vettha – know; parantapa – O scorcher of foes.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Many births of Mine have passed as well as yours. I know them all but you know them not.

VERSE 4.6

अजोऽपि सन्नव्ययात्मा भूतानामीश्वरोऽपि सन् ।
प्रकृतिं स्वामधिष्ठाय सम्भवाम्यात्ममायया ॥ ६ ॥

ajo'pi sannavyayātmā
bhūtānāmīśvaro'pi san |
prakṛtiṃ svāmadhiṣṭhāya
sambhavāmyātmamāyayā ||

◆ ajaḥ – unborn; api – although; san – being; avyaya-ātmā – imperishable Self;
◆ bhūtānām – of beings; īśvaraḥ – the Lord; api – although; san – being; ◆
prakṛtim – nature; svām – My own; adhiṣṭhāya – presiding over/governing; ◆
sambhavāmi – I manifest/come into being; ātma-māyayā – by My own Maya
(creative power).

**Though unborn and eternal in My being, the Lord and
controller of all beings, controlling My own nature, I come
into being by the power of My Maya-Sakti.**